

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 712

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Independence High School boys' cross country team, 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AAA state champions.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we honor those Tennessee students who, through their athletic prowess, have achieved the pinnacle of success and serve as exceptional ambassadors of the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, one such group of estimable individuals is the Independence High School boys' cross country team, which won the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AAA state championship; and

WHEREAS, in addition to winning the first boys' cross country state championship in school history, the young men from Independence High School also won the 2025 Region 7-AAA championship; and

WHEREAS, in the state finals, key runner Asher Oates finished as the individual state runner-up while all seven Independence runners placed in the top thirty-five spots to secure the team title; and

WHEREAS, success in statewide competition is achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the commitment to working together as a team and excelling with a cooperative spirit; the Eagles exhibited each of these rare qualities this season; and

WHEREAS, the boys' cross country team benefited from the astute leadership of Head Coach Luke Finley; and

WHEREAS, the Independence High School Eagles' noteworthy achievement is a tremendous source of pride for their families, their classmates, and their entire community; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the members of the boys' cross country team of Independence High School for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the members and coaches of the Independence High School boys' cross country team, winners of the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class AAA state championship, and extend to them our best wishes for continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.